

C715

Organizational Behavior

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A software firm with a dog-friendly office raised salaries 8% and renovated the break room after a survey showed low motivation. Six months later, complaints dropped but effort and engagement were unchanged. The firm's founder rides a motorcycle to work. What explains the result?

- A. Pay and facilities are hygiene factors: they reduce dissatisfaction but do not motivate.
- B. The raise was too small; a larger raise would have motivated staff.
- C. Motivators and hygiene factors are the same, so the change should have worked.
- D. The dog-friendly office distracted employees.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager wants to increase motivation, not just reduce complaints. According to Herzberg, which change fits best?

- A. Improve the office lighting and chairs.
- B. Clarify company policies.
- C. Give employees ownership of a project and recognize their results.
- D. Raise base pay for everyone.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Two analysts at a busy downtown firm compare pay. Jordan earns \$54,000 and his manager rates his inputs (skill, hours, experience) at 9. Casey earns \$60,000 with inputs rated 12. Jordan, who recently bought a house, feels underpaid because Casey earns more. Using equity theory, how does Jordan's ratio compare?

- A. The ratios are equal.
- B. Jordan is underpaid because \$54,000 is less than \$60,000.
- C. Jordan is underpaid because of his new mortgage.
- D. Jordan's ratio is higher, so by equity theory he is relatively overrewarded.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An employee believes her outcome-to-input ratio is lower than a coworker's. Which response does equity theory predict?

- A.** She reduces her effort or asks for a raise.
- B.** She works harder to earn even less per unit of effort.
- C.** She becomes more satisfied because her coworker is doing well.
- D.** Nothing; equity theory predicts no response.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A project lead, who wears the same navy suit every Monday, arrives late to meetings. Most other team members arrive on time, he is also late to client calls and training sessions, and he has been late to every meeting this month. The meetings are in a conference room on the 9th floor. To what is his lateness most likely attributed?

- A.** Cannot be judged without knowing his dress code.
- B.** External, because lateness is always situational.
- C.** Internal causes, such as his own habits.
- D.** External causes, such as slow elevators.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Every team member missed the new reporting deadline, one employee who missed it meets all her other deadlines, and she missed this one only once. What does Kelley's model suggest about her miss?

- A.** An external cause, such as an unclear or unrealistic deadline.
- B.** An internal cause, such as poor time management.
- C.** No conclusion is possible.
- D.** An internal cause, because observers should blame the person first.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An HR director at a logistics company with a new headquarters wants one personality trait that best predicts performance across all its roles, from accounting to warehouse supervision. The CEO personally favors outgoing candidates. Which trait should she prioritize?

- A. Agreeableness, because friendly people always perform best.
- B. Extraversion.
- C. Openness to experience.
- D. Conscientiousness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A database administrator with no supervisory title and a quiet manner is the only person in the company who fully understands the legacy billing system. Senior managers routinely follow her recommendations. She has worked there since the company's IPO. What power base is she using?

- A. Referent power.
- B. Expert power.
- C. Coercive power.
- D. Legitimate power.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Employees follow a popular team lead's suggestions mainly because they admire her and want to be like her, even though she has no authority over their pay. Which power base is this?

- A. Reward power.
- B. Referent power.
- C. Legitimate power.
- D. Expert power.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A team of veteran claims processors, most with over ten years of experience, handles the same routine claims daily and reports high stress from heavy volume. The office recently switched to a four-day week. Under path-goal theory, which leader behavior fits best?

- A.** Return to a five-day week.
- B.** Achievement-oriented leadership.
- C.** Supportive leadership.
- D.** Directive leadership.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A bank's lobby features posters reading "We value work-life balance," and its offices have standing desks and a juice bar. In practice, managers praise people who answer email at midnight, and those employees get promoted fastest. Which level of culture actually drives behavior here?

- A.** Artifacts such as the standing desks and juice bar.
- B.** Basic underlying assumptions that constant availability is what counts.
- C.** Culture has no influence on promotions.
- D.** Espoused values of work-life balance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A regional sales manager with a corner office is choosing a goal for her team for next quarter. The team hit \$1.8 million last quarter and has strong morale. Which goal is most likely to raise performance?

- A.** Do your best.
- B.** Reach \$1.8 million again.
- C.** Reach \$6 million, since harder goals always produce more effort.
- D.** Reach \$2.1 million with weekly progress updates.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A software firm ~~with a dog-friendly office~~ raised salaries 8% and renovated the break room after a survey showed low motivation. Six months later, complaints dropped but effort and engagement were unchanged. ~~The firm's founder rides a motorcycle to work.~~ What explains the result?

Target word: why engagement did not rise **Decides:** Pay and facilities are hygiene factors.

A	Correct	Motivation needs motivators such as recognition, growth, and meaningful work.
B	Adjacent category	More of a hygiene factor still does not create motivation.
C	Confusion set	Herzberg's point is that they are separate.
D	Camouflage	An incidental detail that does not explain the pattern.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A manager wants to increase motivation, not just reduce complaints. According to Herzberg, which change fits best?

Target word: choose a motivator **Decides:** Motivators relate to job content.

A	Inverted operation	Working conditions are hygiene factors.
B	Confusion set	Policies are a hygiene factor.
C	Correct	Responsibility and recognition are motivators.
D	Confusion set	Pay is a hygiene factor.

3. Answer D Concept 2

Two analysts ~~at a busy downtown firm~~ compare pay. Jordan earns \$54,000 and his manager rates his inputs (skill, hours, experience) at 9. Casey earns \$60,000 with inputs rated 12. ~~Jordan, who recently bought a house,~~ feels underpaid because Casey earns more. Using equity theory, how does Jordan's ratio compare?

Target word: compare ratios **Decides:** $\$54,000 / 9 = \$6,000$ vs. $\$60,000 / 12 = \$5,000$.

A	Wrong stem number	They are \$6,000 and \$5,000, not equal.
B	Dropped element	Drops inputs; equity compares outcome-to-input ratios.
C	Camouflage	Personal expenses are not part of the comparison.
D	Correct	\$6,000 per input point exceeds Casey's \$5,000.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

An employee believes her outcome-to-input ratio is lower than a coworker's. Which response does equity theory predict?

Target word: predicted response to underpayment **Decides:** Restore balance by lowering inputs or raising outcomes.

A	Correct	Both restore balance between the ratios.
B	Inverted operation	Raising inputs worsens her ratio.
C	Adjacent category	That is not how the social comparison works.
D	Absolute language	Perceived inequity creates tension that drives action.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A project lead, ~~who wears the same navy suit every Monday~~, arrives late to meetings. Most other team members arrive on time, he is also late to client calls and training sessions, and he has been late to every meeting this month. ~~The meetings are in a conference room on the 9th floor.~~ To what is his lateness most likely attributed?

Target word: internal or external **Decides:** Low consensus, low distinctiveness, high consistency.

A	Dropped element	The three covariation cues are all present; dress is irrelevant.
B	Absolute language	The cues here clearly point inward.
C	Correct	Only he is late, he is late everywhere, and he is late every time.
D	Camouflage	Reacts to the floor detail; others arrive on time.

6. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

Every team member missed the new reporting deadline, one employee who missed it meets all her other deadlines, and she missed this one only once. What does Kelley's model suggest about her miss?

Target word: attribution from cues **Decides:** High consensus, high distinctiveness, low consistency.

A	Correct	Those three cues all point to the situation.
B	Inverted operation	Internal attributions need low consensus and high consistency.
C	Dropped element	All three cues are given.
D	Adjacent category	That is the fundamental attribution error, not the model's guidance.

7. Answer D Concept 4

An HR director at a logistics company ~~with a new headquarters~~ wants one personality trait that best predicts performance across all its roles, from accounting to warehouse supervision. The CEO personally favors outgoing candidates. Which trait should she prioritize?

Target word: best general predictor **Decides:** Conscientiousness predicts performance across jobs.

A	Absolute language	Agreeableness helps in service roles but is not the strongest general predictor.
B	Camouflage	Reflects the CEO's preference; extraversion helps mainly in social roles like sales.
C	Confusion set	Predicts training success and creativity more than general performance.
D	Correct	It is the most consistent Big Five predictor of performance across occupations.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A database administrator with no supervisory title ~~and a quiet manner~~ is the only person in the company who fully understands the legacy billing system. Senior managers routinely follow her recommendations. ~~She has worked there since the company's IPO.~~ What power base is she using?

Target word: name the power base **Decides:** Influence comes from knowledge.

A	Confusion set	Referent power comes from being admired or liked.
B	Correct	Specialized knowledge others depend on gives expert power.
C	Confusion set	She is not threatening punishment.
D	Adjacent category	She has no formal position of authority.

9. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

Employees follow a popular team lead's suggestions mainly because they admire her and want to be like her, even though she has no authority over their pay. Which power base is this?

Target word: name the power base **Decides:** Admiration and identification.

A	Inverted operation	She controls no rewards, the opposite of the stem.
B	Correct	Influence based on admiration is referent power.
C	Adjacent category	Position authority is not the source here.
D	Confusion set	No specialized knowledge is mentioned.

10. Answer C Concept 6

A team of veteran claims processors, most with over ten years of experience, handles the same routine claims daily and reports high stress from heavy volume. ~~The office recently switched to a four day week.~~ Under path-goal theory, which leader behavior fits best?

Target word: fitting leader behavior **Decides:** Routine, clear tasks with experienced, stressed staff.

A	Camouflage	The schedule change is not the leadership behavior asked about.
B	Adjacent category	Fits challenging, novel goals, not routine high-volume work.
C	Correct	Stressful, routine work calls for concern and encouragement, not more direction.
D	Inverted operation	Directive fits ambiguous tasks or new staff; these tasks are clear.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A bank's lobby features posters reading "We value work-life balance," ~~and its offices have standing desks and a juice bar.~~ In practice, managers praise people who answer email at midnight, and those employees get promoted fastest. Which level of culture actually drives behavior here?

Target word: identify the operative level **Decides:** Unspoken assumptions override espoused values.

A	Camouflage	Visible artifacts do not reveal what truly drives behavior.
B	Correct	Promotions reveal the real, unspoken belief.
C	Absolute language	Promotion patterns are a clear expression of culture.
D	Inverted operation	Stated values conflict with what is rewarded.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A regional sales manager ~~with a corner office~~ is choosing a goal for her team for next quarter. The team hit \$1.8 million last quarter ~~and has strong morale.~~ Which goal is most likely to raise performance?

Target word: best goal type **Decides:** Specific, difficult, attainable goal with feedback.

A	Dropped element	Drops specificity; vague goals produce lower performance.
B	Wrong stem number	Last quarter's figure; not a stretch goal.
C	Absolute language	Difficulty helps only while the goal stays attainable; impossible goals are rejected.
D	Correct	Specific, challenging but attainable, and paired with feedback.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Herzberg's two-factor theory	Hygiene factors (pay, policies, working conditions, supervision) prevent dissatisfaction but do not motivate; motivators (achievement, recognition, responsibility, growth, the work itself) create satisfaction and motivation.	Expecting a raise or better office to produce lasting motivation.	A fix aimed at conditions around the job vs. the content of the job.
2	Equity theory	People compare their ratio of outcomes to inputs with a referent's ratio; a lower ratio feels like underpayment and leads people to cut inputs, seek more outcomes, or change the referent.	Comparing only pay and ignoring inputs.	Two people's pay alongside their effort, experience, or hours.
3	Attribution and Kelley's covariation	Low consensus, low distinctiveness, and high consistency point to an internal cause; high consensus, high distinctiveness, and low consistency point to an external cause. Observers tend to overweight internal causes for others (fundamental attribution error).	Blaming the person by default without checking the three cues.	Whether others behave the same way, whether the person acts this way in other situations, and whether it happens every time.
4	Big Five and job performance	Of the Big Five (openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, emotional stability), conscientiousness is the most consistent predictor of performance across jobs.	Assuming extraversion predicts success in every job.	A hiring question asking which trait best predicts performance generally.
5	Bases of power	Legitimate power comes from position; reward and coercive power from control of rewards and punishments; expert power from knowledge; referent power from being admired or liked.	Calling any influence by a manager legitimate power.	Why people comply: the title, the carrot, the stick, the know-how, or the admiration.
6	Path-goal theory	Leaders should supply what the situation lacks: directive behavior for ambiguous tasks or inexperienced staff; supportive behavior for stressful, routine, or boring tasks; participative for staff who want input; achievement-oriented for skilled staff on challenging goals.	Giving detailed direction on routine tasks experienced staff already know.	Task clarity and employee experience in the scenario.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
7	Levels of organizational culture	Schein's levels are artifacts (visible structures, dress, office layout), espoused values (stated beliefs), and basic underlying assumptions (unspoken beliefs that actually drive behavior).	Reading culture from artifacts or stated values alone.	A gap between what the company says it values and how people actually behave.
8	Goal-setting theory	Specific, difficult but attainable goals, accepted by the employee and paired with feedback, lead to higher performance than vague "do your best" goals.	Believing easy or vague goals motivate more because they avoid failure.	A comparison of goal types for a team.

Course scope (public description): Organizational Behavior and Leadership explores how to lead and manage effectively in diverse business environments. Students are asked to demonstrate the ability to apply organizational leadership theories and management strategies in a series of scenario-based problems.